Program for NExT Workshop 2026
Theme: Responsible AI (RAi)

I4, NUS, Singapore (29 April to 1 May 2026)
Pre-Workshop on RAi Sandpit (25-28 April 2026)

25-28 April (Sat-Tue): Pre-Workshop Event -Responsible AI (RAi) Sandpit

- Pre-workshop event organized with RAi, UK
- An intensive discussion forum involving researchers from Singapore, UK and China.
- Involving post-docs, mentors and other professors from NUS, UK and China.
- Aims: to promote multi-country and multi-disciplinary research, and to propose new RAi initiatives.

29 April (Wed): Day-1 of Workshop

- 0830-0930: Opening and Invited Talks—Chair: Maosong Sun (Tsinghua)
  - 0830-0850: Opening Remarks: Prof Tat-Seng Chua & Prof Maosong Sun
  - 0850-0910: Invited Talk: Prof Bo Zhang (Tsinghua): From LLMs to Agentic AI
  - 0910-0930: Invited Talk: Prof Dame Wendy Hall (Univ of Southampton): Unintended Consequences

- 0930-1000: Group Photo & Teas

- 1000-1230: Responsible AI—Chair: Joel Fisher (RAi UK/Univ of Nottingham)
  - 1000-1130: Reports on RAi Sandpits
    - Introduction to RAi UK and Responsible AI Assurance
    - Proposals from the RAi UK/NExT International Sandpit 'Advancing the RAI Assurance Model Across Cultures'
    - Short Research Talks
  - 1130-1230: Panel on Responsible AI: Facilitator: Prof Dame Wendy Hall (Southampton)
    Panelists: Jie Tang (Tsinghua); Joel Fisher (Nottingham); Kate Devlin (King's College London); Owen Schaefer (NUS)

- 1230-1400: Lunch & Posters

- 1400-1540: Agentic AI-1—Chair: Lizi Liao (SMU)
  - 1400-1425: Prof Yuxiao Dong (Tsinghua): Advancing Agentic LLMs through RL and Inference Scaling
  - 1425-1450: Dr. Long Bai (Institute of Computing): Knowledge Graph in Agentic AI
  - 1450-1515: Prof Hongning Wang (Tsinghua): Agentic System for Interactive Education
  - 1515-1540: Alan Zhao (ScitiX): Monitoring Safety Drift During Fine-Tuning

- 1540-1600: Teas

- 1600-1740: Agentic AI -2—Chair: Hongning Wang (Tsinghua)
  - 1600-1625: Prof Jiaheng Zhang (NUS): Practical LLM Auditing Framework via Verifiable Computation
  - 1625-1650: Dr. Dan Zhang (NUS): Scaling up Trust in Agentic System
  - 1650-1740: Panel: Risks & Opportunities in Agentic AI Era: Chair by Prof Hongning Wang (Tsinghua)
    Panelists: Yuxiao Dong (Tsinghua); Jiaheng Zhang (NUS); Chao Wang (6Estates)

- 1830-2100: Dinner: Yummy Palace, Hougang

30 April (Thu): Day-2 of Workshop

- 0900-1015: AI+X – Healthcare—Chair: Zhenkai Liang (NUS)
  - 0900-0925: Prof Ramesh Jain (UC Irvine): We need Personal Care Utility
  - 0925-0950: Prof Yang Liu (Tsinghua): Agent Hospital
  - 0950-1010: Prof Wynne Hsu (NUS): My journey with AI in Medicine
  - 1010-1030: Ms. Venus Cheung (OPH): AI Empowering Primary Healthcare Transformation

- 1030-1050: Coffee Break

- 1050-1200: Search & Personalization—Chair: Min Zhang (Tsinghua)
  - 1050-1115: Prof Thanassis Tiropanis (U of Southampton): The promise and the challenges of Decentralised Information Retrieval
  - 1115-1140: Dr. Yujia Zhou (Tsinghua): RAG and Search
  - 1140-1200: Dr. Yang Zhang (NUS): Personalization and Memory

- 1210-1400: Special Lunch Session for PhD/Post-Doc (Presentation & Open Discussion)
  Facilitators: Dan Zhang & Yang Zhang (NUS)
  Venue: COM4-L4 Meeting Room
- 1210-1400: Lunch in Foyer of I4 (for those who are not joining PhD/Post-Doc Session)

- 1410-1440: Presentations of PhD/Post-Doc Sessions —Chair: Dan Zhang / Yang Zhang (NUS)

- 1440-1620: Embodied AI—Chair: Zhiyong Huang (NUS)
  - 1440-1505: Prof Shuicheng Yan (NUS): Agent-Nex: Inference Acceleration & Generative Memory
  - 1505-1530: Prof Cathal Gurrin (Dublin City Univ): CASTLE: Modeling Human Daily Activities and Interactions
  - 1530-1555: Prof Daquan Zhou (Peking Univ): Building Reliable Vision-Language-Action Model
  - 1555-1620: Prof Mike Shou (NUS): From Video Generation to World Model for Robot Learning

- 1620-1630: Closing: Maosong Sun (Tsinghua)
  - Prof Wei Ji (Nanjing Univ): Announcement of NExT Workshop in Suzhou on 23-24 October 2026

- Outdoor Walk cum Dinner: Changi Coastal Walk and Georges@ Changi Sailing Club

1 May (Fri): Planning

- Half day tour for participants and family